FORD F-150

12” Screen Upgrade Kit

Installation Guide | Simply Michigan Infotainment

BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Confirm that the vehicle already has Sync 3 and that its software has been updated to version 3.4. Please read these instructions thoroughly before installing this upgrade and ensure you have all of the required tools and parts. Please contact us if you have any questions.

Check the installed Sync version

- Turn on your vehicle and open Settings
- Select General, then click About
- Confirm that the software version shown at the top is 3.4

This is intended as a do-it-yourself upgrade. The work is straightforward, but set aside enough time to work slowly to avoid any accidents, broken parts, etc. There are videos for this installation on YouTube that should be helpful but ours may vary slightly. Safety and handling

BEFORE INSTALLING…	Keep the vehicle off during disassembly. Start it only when instructed during the display test in Step 8.

- Use only the specified screw size at each marked location. A screw that is too long can damage the visible side of the bezel.
- Do not over tighten screws. Tighten only until the component is secure.
- Ribbon cables and their connectors are fragile. Do not twist, crease, or pull on the cables.
- If you are not comfortable completing the installation, ask a capable helper or a professional radio installer.

Screw reference

Each screw set includes one extra screw. Sort the screws before beginning and keep each size separated.

ID	Size	Finish	Included	Used in guide
1	3 mm x 10 mm	Black	15	Figures 6, 9 and 17
2	3 mm x 16 mm	Silver	9	Figures 7 and 10
3	2.6 mm x 10 mm	Silver	4	Figure 11
4	4 mm x 8 mm	-	4	Figure 18
5	2.6 mm x 8 mm	Black	4	Supplied trim hardware

NEED HELP?	Contact us if a step is unclear, we’re always here to help! E-mail us **nick@simplymichigan.co**

1 Remove the original HVAC controls

- Remove the existing HVAC control panel from the vehicle.
- Use the included T8 Torx bit to remove the rear cover and expose the circuit board.
- Remove the circuit board, knobs, and buttons for transfer to the new bezel.

RIBBON CABLES	Be careful with the ribbon cables as they are easily damaged. If you accidentally damage one please contact us and we may have replacements available, but it’s not guaranteed (it’s not something we regularly stock but sometimes do have on hand). It is recommended that you unattached the ribbon cables from the boards and reconnect it later but you may keep them connected if you’re **extremely careful**, don’t put excessive stress on them or twist them. The instructions in this guide are for users who disconnect them and reattach them back together at the end. ⚠ **Damage to the boards and/or ribbon cables can easily happen, to reiterate, please be careful. When you finish your installation and find that your HVAC functions no longer work please double check your connections on the back of of the HVAC panel and your ribbon cable connections. If it continues to still not work replacement PCB boards for will need to be ordered.**

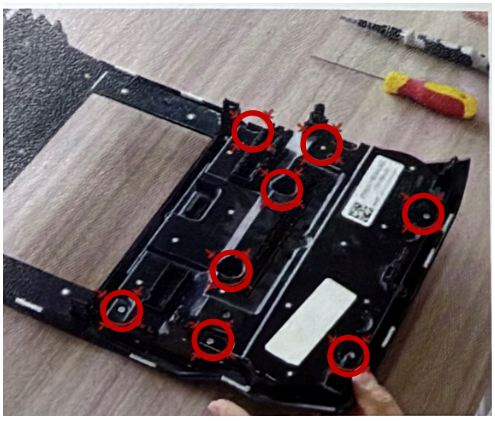


Figure 1. Remove the rear cover screws from the original control panel.

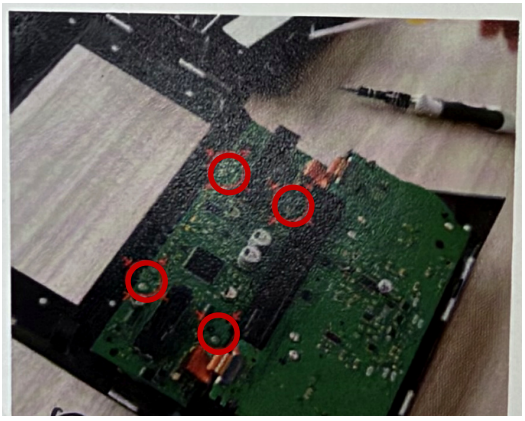


Figure 2. Remove the circuit board screws at the circled locations.

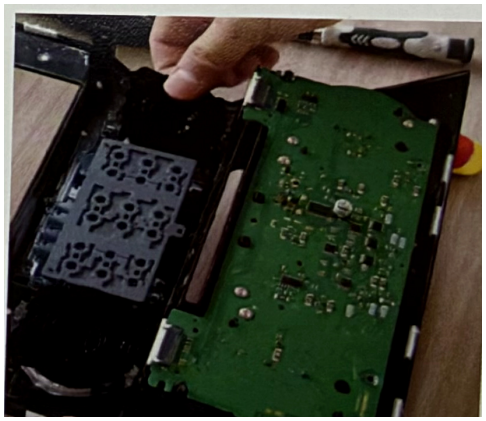


Figure 3. Lift the circuit board carefully from the original housing.



Figure 4. Set the board, knobs, buttons, and button pads aside for transfer.

2 Transfer the controls to the large bezel

- Install the original buttons and knobs into the supplied large HVAC bezel, we’ll refer to this bezel as the “large bezel” moving forward in the instructions.
- Place the original circuit board into the large bezel as shown.
- Install the screws in the circled locations shown below.

CRITICAL SCREW PLACEMENT	Screws are various sizes and they’re intended for a certain position on the board, the positions are marked with red circles in the diagram below.

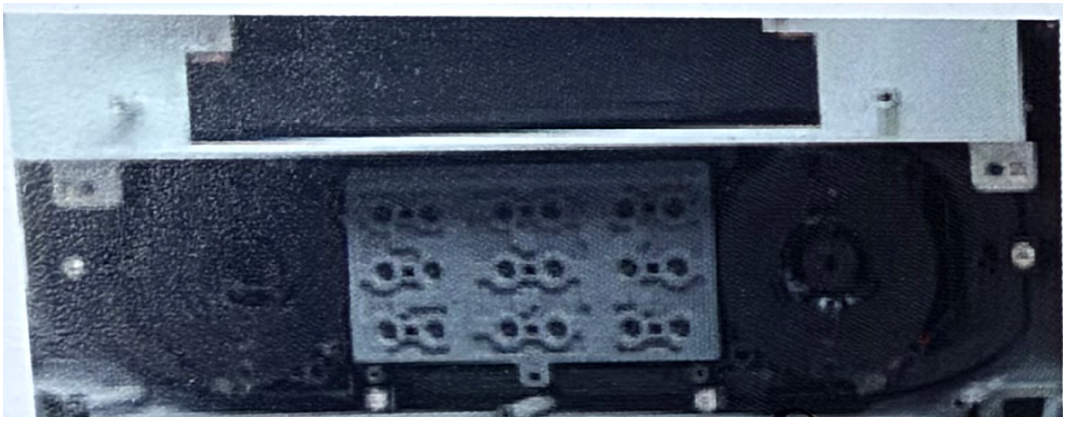


Figure 5. Large bezel with the transferred controls installed.

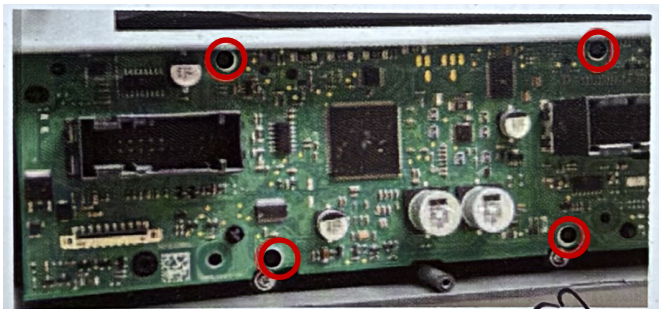


Figure 6. Install four 3 mm x 10 mm black screws at the circled locations

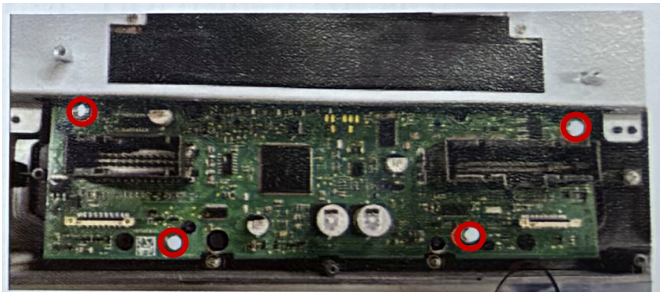


Figure 7. Install four 3 mm x 16 mm silver screws at the circled locations

- Install the temperature and fan speed knobs and buttons into the supplied small bezel (the small bezel will attach to the large bezel later on)
- Place its circuit board behind the controls and align the marked screw holes.

CRITICAL SCREW PLACEMENT	Screws are various sizes and they’re intended for a certain position on the board, the positions are marked with red circles in the diagram below.



Figure 8. Small bezel with the transferred controls installed.

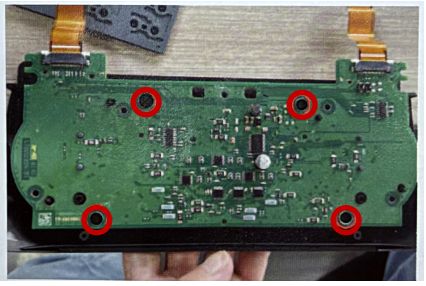


Figure 9. Install four 3 mm x 10 mm black screws at the circled locations

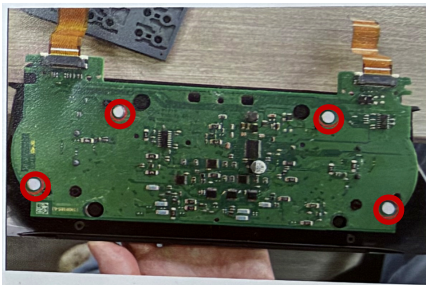


Figure 10. Install four 3 mm x 16 mm silver screws at the circled locations

4 Join the small and large bezels

- Align the small bezel with the large bezel and secure the two assemblies together.

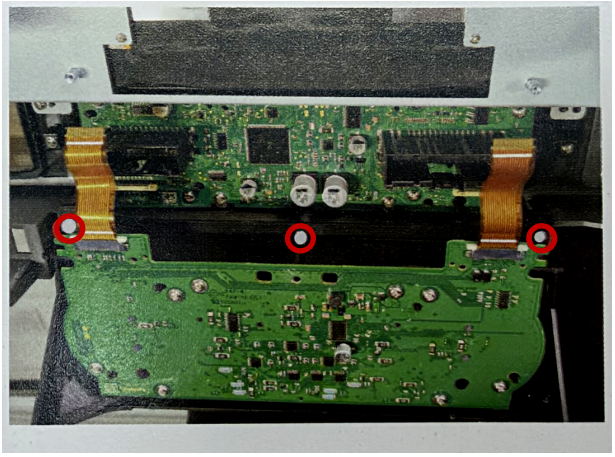


Figure 11. Install three 2.6 mm x 10 mm silver screws at the circled locations.

CRITICAL SCREW PLACEMENT	Screws are various sizes and they’re intended for a certain position on the board, the positions are marked with red circles in the diagram below.

5 Connect everything together

- Connect the ribbon cables to the board inside the large bezel first, then connect them to the board in the small bezel.
- Apply the included thermal fabric electrical tape over the connector areas shown. The tape helps protect the cables during final assembly.

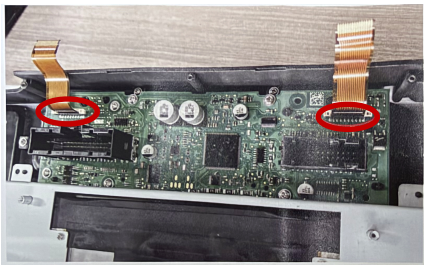


Figure 12. Seat both ribbon cables fully in the upper circuit board.

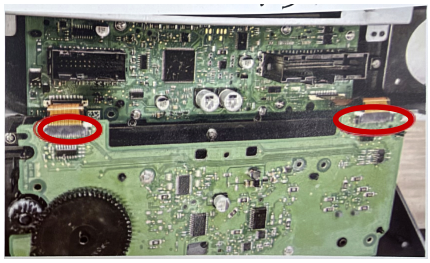


Figure 13. Seat both ribbon cables fully in the lower circuit board.

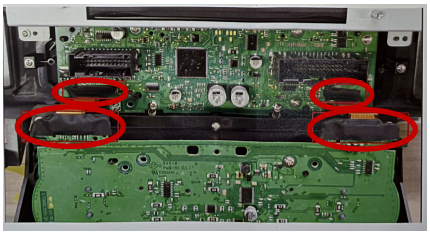


Figure 14. Apply the supplied fabric tape over the four marked connector areas.

TAKE YOUR TIME	The ribbon connectors protrude from the boards and can be damaged by the cover. Do not force the cover into position.

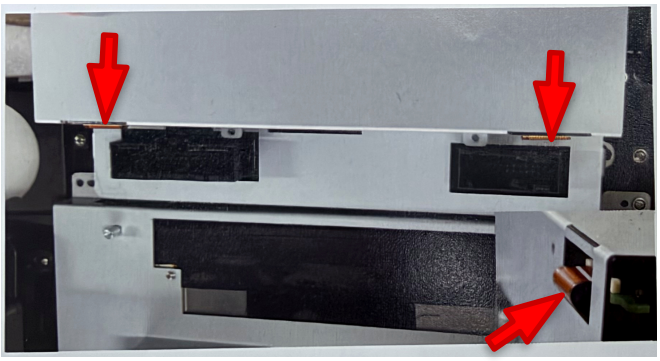


Figure 15. Confirm the ribbon cables clear the cover plate edges.

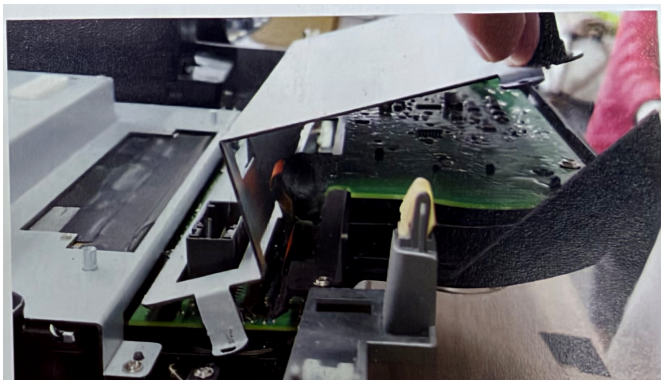


Figure 16. Install the cover plate at an angle, then lower it carefully into position.

6 Install the rear metal frame

- After both circuit boards and ribbon cables are secure, place the rear metal frame over the small-bezel assembly.

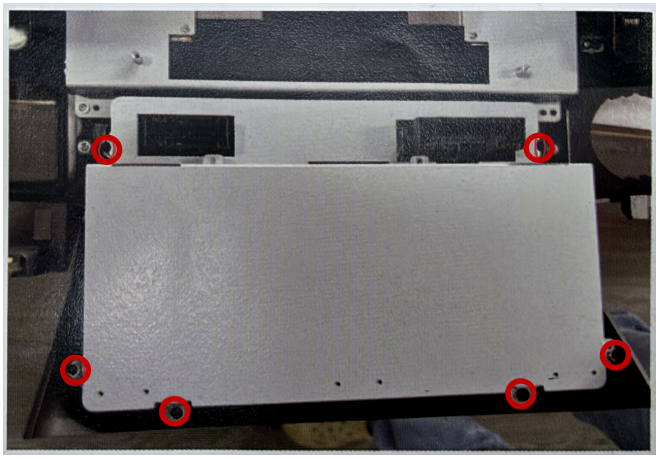


Figure 17. Secure the rear frame with six 3 mm x 10 mm black screws at the circled locations.

CHECKPOINT	The complete HVAC bezel assembly should now be secure. Verify that no ribbon cable is pinched before continuing.

7 Mount the APIM to the supplied bracket

- Attach the APIM module to the supplied bracket. When installed in the vehicle, the APIM faces rearward toward the engine.
- Before mounting the bracket, connect the vehicle harness, the supplied conversion harness, and the display cable to the APIM.
- Mount the bracket loosely at first. You may need access to the APIM connector during Step 8.

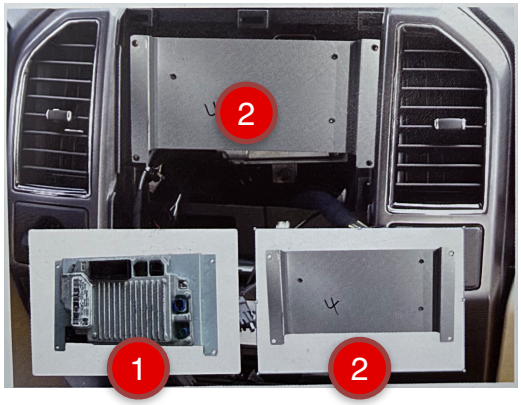


Figure 18. APIM and bracket orientation. Use three 4 mm x 8 mm screws.

8 Test the display and finish the installation

- Connect the display cable to the new screen, but do not fully reassemble the dashboard yet.
- Start the vehicle and test the screen and touch controls
- If the image appears in a smaller 8 inch area, disconnect and reconnect the APIM 52 pin connector (connector 1 shown in the image below) while the vehicle is running. Repeat until the image fills the complete 12 inch display
- After the display fills the screen and touch operation is normal, disconnect the small connector (connector 2, shown in the image below) on the conversion harness
- Tighten the bracket hardware, secure all connectors, and reassemble the dashboard

DO NOT RESTART WITH THE IGNITION	When correcting a small or non-responsive display, restart the infotainment system by disconnecting and reconnecting the APIM 52 pin connector while the vehicle remains running.

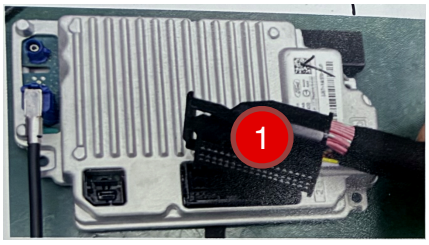


Figure 19. Connector 1, the APIM 52-pin connector used to restart the infotainment system.



Figure 20. Example of the smaller 8 inch image before the system is restarted.



Figure 21. Correct full screen 12 inch display.

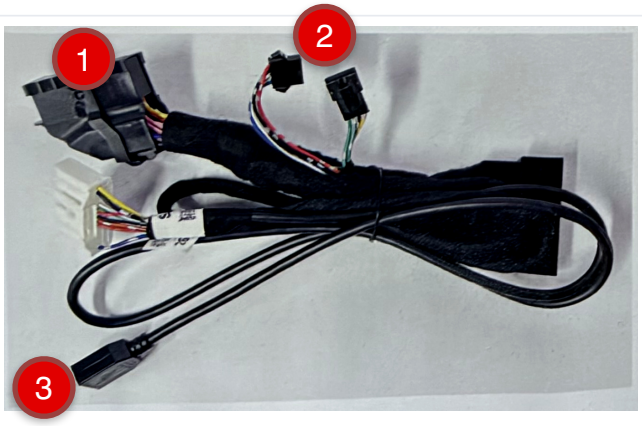


Figure 22. This is the main conversion harness. Route the small female USB port to an accessible location (connector 3 in the picture above), such as your glove box or under the dash, this port is used for future updates if needed; disconnect Connector 2 after the display operates correctly.

Parts and supplied hardware

The exact trim pieces supplied depend on whether the vehicle has manual climate controls or automatic climate controls with separate seat control buttons.

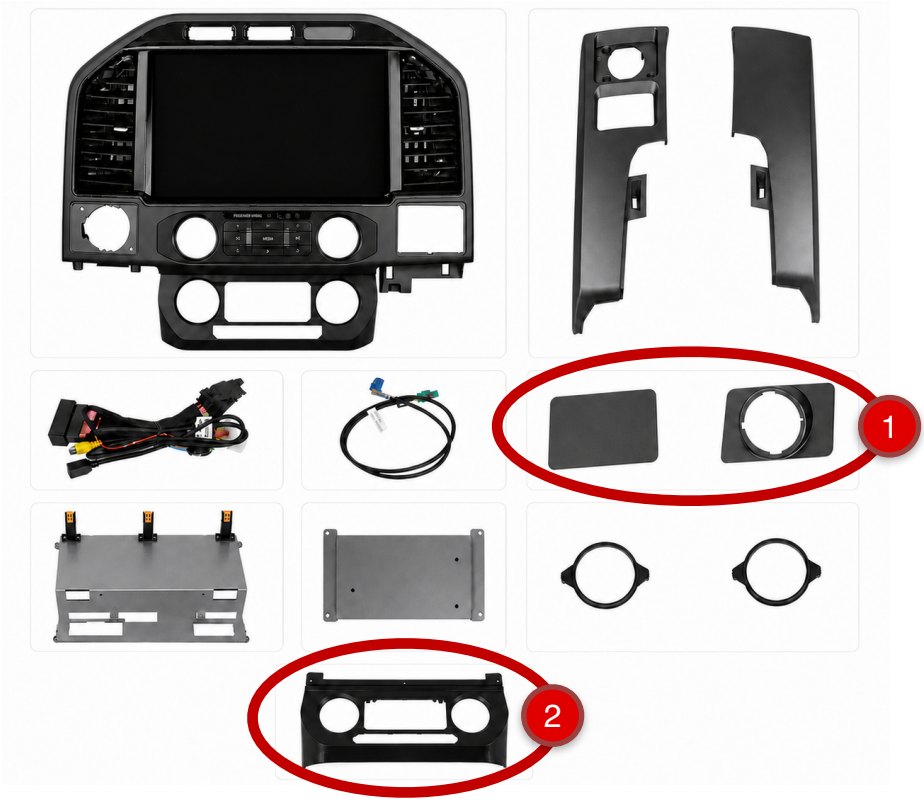


Figure 23. Your kit will include one of the two small bezels (item #2 in the photo above), depending on if you have the automatic climate controls with separate seat controls or manual climate controls.

Your kit will include one of the two small covers (item #1 in the photo above). Use the supplied screws to secure it to the main large HVAC bezel.

Also included, not shown

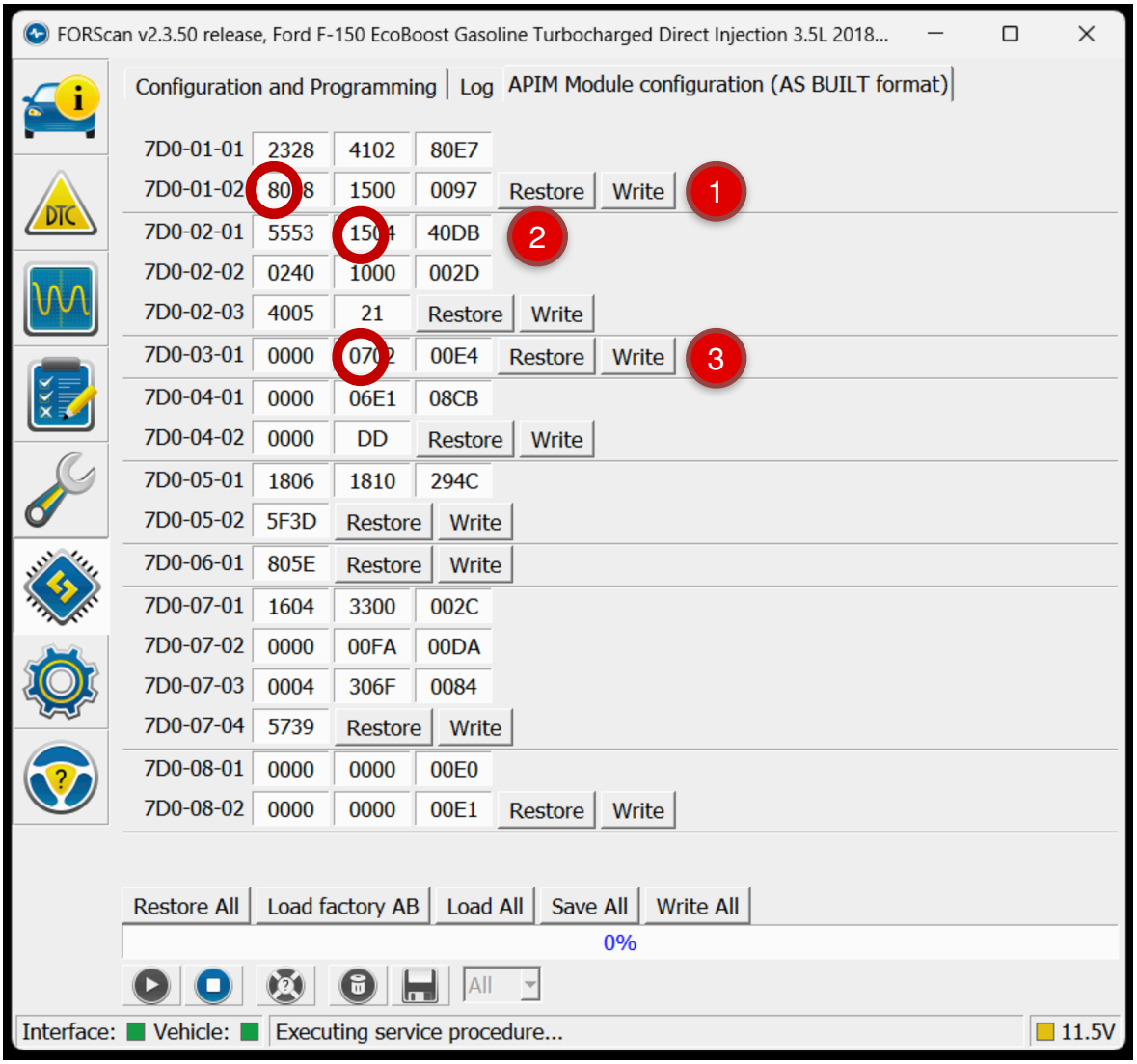
Item	Purpose
T8 Torx bit	Used to open the original HVAC control panel.
Plastic pry tools	Used to remove dashboard trim without marring visible surfaces.
Thermal fabric electrical tape	Applied over the ribbon cable connector areas in Step 5.
Upper HVAC bezel bracket	Provides a mounting point for the vehicle's upper storage tray.
Side cover plate	Use the supplied screws to secure the cover to the bezel.

FORScan changes

In rare cases, the screen may not switch to the 12-inch layout automatically. If the restart procedure in Step 8 does not correct the display, use FORScan to make the three APIM adjustments below.

BACK UP FIRST	Save the vehicle's original APIM configuration before making changes. Change only the indicated character positions

APIM line	Change	Result
1 **7D0-01-02**	Set the first digit to 8.	Sets the gray Lincoln theme. This position must be 8. Trying to set it to the Ford blue theme will revert it back to the 8” size.
2 **7D0-02-01**	Set the fifth digit to 1 and the sixth digit to 5.	Enables the Ford startup logo.
3 **7D0-03-01**	Set the fifth digit to 0 and the sixth digit to 7.	Configures the 12” screen layout.



Troubleshooting

I DON’T HAVE AN IMAGE	Confirm that the APIM, conversion harness, and display connectors are fully seated. The vehicle should be running during the display test.
I DON’T HAVE TOUCH CONTROLS	With the vehicle running, disconnect and reconnect the APIM 52 pin connector. Do not stop and restart the engine for this procedure.
THE IMAGE ISN’T USING THE ENTIRE 12” SCREEN	With the vehicle running, disconnect and reconnect the APIM 52 pin connector. Repeat if needed. If the image still does not fill the screen, use the FORScan reference above.
ONE OR MORE ASPECTS OF THE HVAC CONTROLS AREN’T WORKING	Verify that both ribbon cables are fully seated and undamaged. Recheck all connectors on the rear of the bezel.
I REALLY WANT THE FORD BLUE THEME	Unfortunately this isn’t possible as-is however it can be done with a jailbroken module. This would involve jailbreaking the module then installing some custom code on the module; after that you would be able to set the Ford blue theme. Please reach out for additional information if you’re interested.
HOW DO I FIX THE CARPLAY ICON OR THE LINCOLN FAREWELL MESSAGE WHEN SHUTTING OFF THE VEHICLE?	This would also involve jailbreaking the module then installing some custom code on the module to allow this to function properly; after this is complete you would be able to change these settings.

installation checklist

Complete these checks before reinstalling all dashboard trim.

- □ The image fills the complete 12” screen.
- □ Touch controls respond throughout the display.
- □ Audio, steering wheel controls, and the backup camera operate normally.
- □ Heating, air conditioning, fan speed, and all HVAC buttons operate normally.
- □ Both ribbon cables are fully seated, protected with fabric tape, and not pinched.
- □ Connector 2 on the conversion harness has been disconnected after successful testing.
- □ The APIM bracket and all bezel hardware are secure without overtightening.
- □ The service USB port is routed to an accessible, protected location.
- □ All dashboard trim is aligned before applying final pressure to the clips.

INSTALLATION COMPLETE	After every item above passes, reinstall the remaining trim and enjoy the upgraded display.

Support

If you need help during installation, please reach out to us, we would be happy to help. Describe the step you are on and include a clear photo of what you’re having issues with.